



ADVERTISEMENT • [GO](#)
[AD](#)
[FREE](#)

PODCAST

Podcast: The Government Wants to End Anonymity on Phones

 JOSEPH COX • JUN 17, 2026 AT 9:16 AM

The FCC's proposed changes to getting a phone plan; cops keep stalking with Flock; and a software update changes the AC in Amazon vans.



We start this week with Joseph's story about the FCC's wild proposal to require peoples' government ID numbers to even get a phone plan. The FCC is doing it to curb robocalls, but also said it would be useful for a bunch of other stuff. After the break, Jason tells us all about cops abusing Flock to stalk girlfriends and other people. In the subscribers' only section, Emanuel explains how a software update is impacting Amazon drivers.



The 404 Media Podcast

The Government Wants to End Anonymit...



 [SAVE TO SPOTIFY](#) [SHARE](#) [SUBSCRIBE](#) [DESCRIPTION](#)



Listen to the weekly podcast on [Apple Podcasts](#), [Spotify](#), or [YouTube](#). Become a paid subscriber for access to this episode's bonus content and to power our journalism. **If you become a paid subscriber, check your inbox for an email from our podcast host Transistor for a link to the subscribers-only version!** You can also add that subscribers feed to your podcast app of choice and never miss an episode that way. The email should also contain the subscribers-only unlisted YouTube link for the extended video version too. It will also be in the show notes in your podcast player.

- [FCC Wants to Kill Burner Phones By Forcing Telecoms to Get All Customers' IDs](#)
- [Cops Keep Getting Arrested for Using Flock to Stalk People](#)
- [Software Update Automatically Turns off Amazon Delivery Drivers' AC During Dangerous Summer Heat](#)

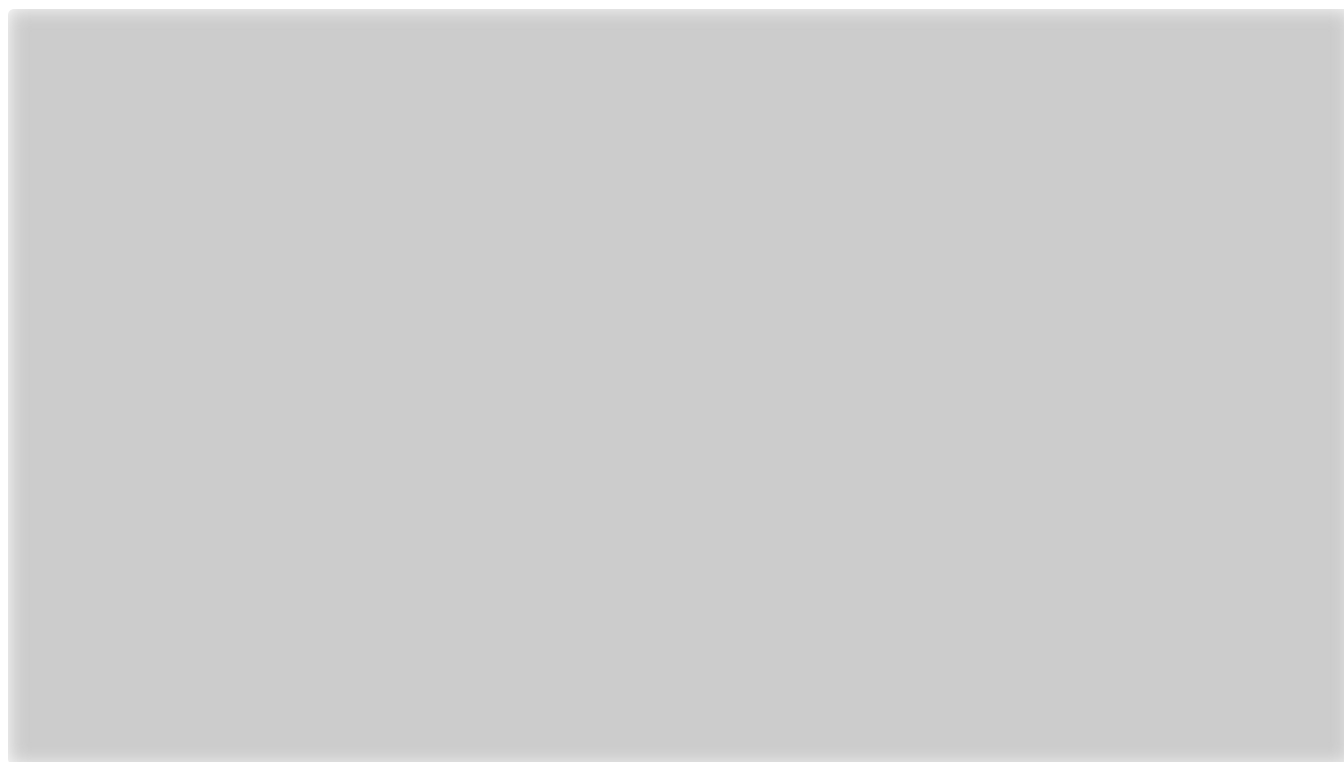
ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Joseph is an award-winning investigative journalist focused on generating impact. His work has triggered hundreds of millions of dollars worth of fines, shut down tech companies, and much more.



[MORE FROM JOSEPH COX](#)

MORE LIKE THIS

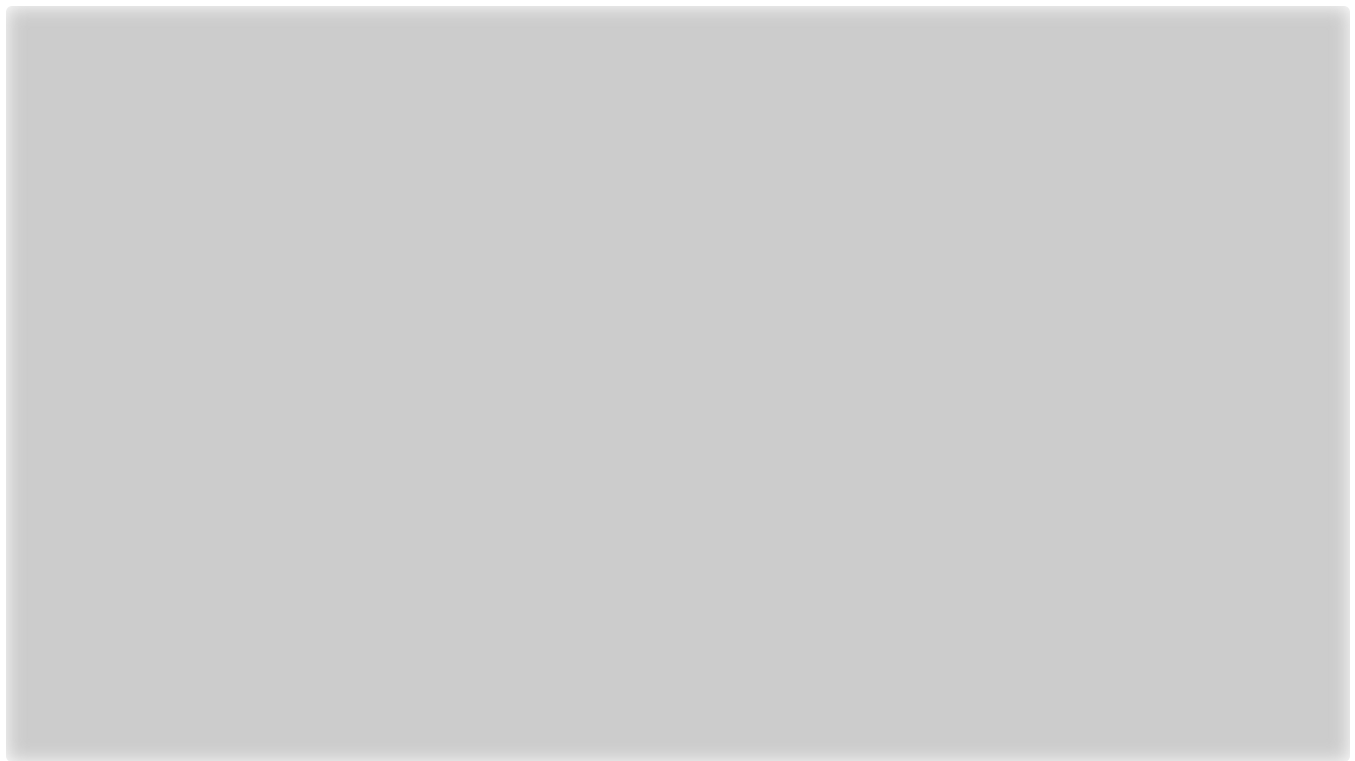


The OPSEC Rave Wave (with Imani Thompson)

We get into how platforms have tried to make surveillance cute, why that damn Duolingo owl emotionally manipulates you, and why learning about privacy best practices when surrounded by community works.



SAMANTHA COLE · JUN 15, 2026

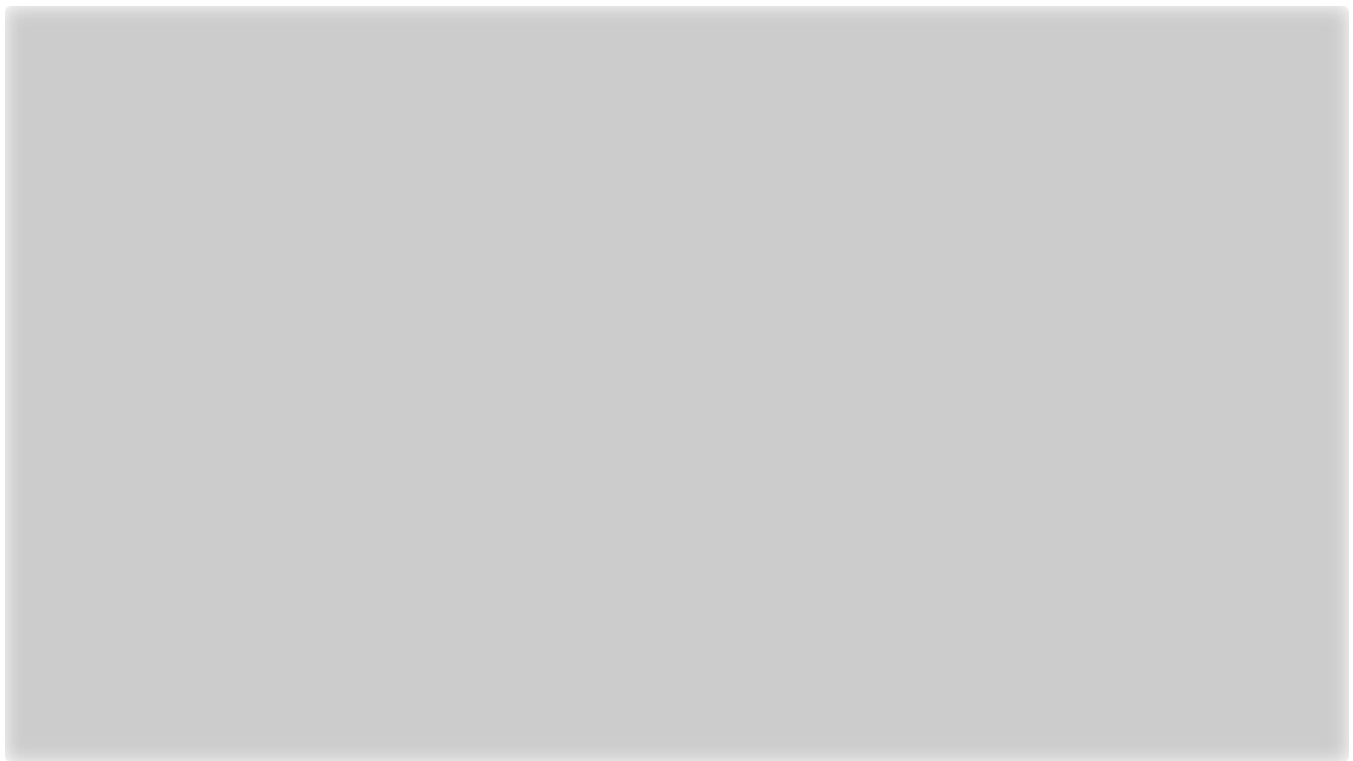


Podcast: Google Employees Meme About How Bad Their AI Is

Memes at Google; Microsoft wants to make its new AI assistant addictive; and manipulating Reddit.



JOSEPH COX · JUN 10, 2026



It's So Not Over for Hollywood (with Devindra Hardawar)

Emanuel talks to Devindra Hardawar about AI in Hollywood and the state of the movie industry.



EMANUEL MAIBERG · JUN 8, 2026



Unparalleled access to hidden worlds both online and IRL.

404 Media is an independent media company founded by technology journalists Jason Koebler, Emanuel Maiberg, Samantha Cole, and Joseph Cox.

[About](#)

[RSS](#)

[Support/FAQ](#)

[Podcast](#)

[FOIA Forum Archive](#)

[Merch](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Privacy](#)

[Contact Us/Tips](#)

[Twitter](#)

[Bluesky](#)

[Mastodon](#)

[Instagram](#)

[TikTok](#)

[Facebook](#)

[RSS](#)

Join the newsletter to get the latest updates.

Your email



© 2026 404 MEDIA. PUBLISHED WITH [GHOST](#).